The Code

How to get it, read it, and change it safely

Read this part first

The code lives in **two separate places**, and this matters:

1. The server. This is the live website. Changing a file here changes what visitors see, immediately.

2. Your copy. A copy you download onto your own computer. Changing a file here changes **nothing** that anybody can see.

Everything in this guide happens in **your copy**. You cannot break the website by following this guide.

Part 1 - Getting your own copy

1	Ask Jason to make you a Gitea account. You cannot do this step yourself. You will see: A username and a password from Jason.
2	Open your browser and go to: `https://jasonagibson.zapto.org/git/` You will see: A sign-in page.
3	Sign in with the username and password Jason gave you. You will see: A page listing repositories.
4	Click your name at the top right, then **Settings**, then **Applications**. You will see: A section titled **Access Tokens**.
5	Type a name for the token. Any name. **my-laptop** is fine. Then click **Generate Token**. You will see: A long string of letters and numbers.
6	**Copy that string now and save it somewhere safe.** Gitea will never show it to you again. If you lose it, make a new one.
7	Install Git on your computer if it is not there. Ask Jason, or search for **git for windows download**.

8 Open a Command Prompt window. Type this and press Enter:

```
git clone http://jasonagibson.zapto.org/git/sonshine518/junsgarden.git
```

When it asks for a username, type your Gitea username. When it asks for a password, **paste the token** from step 6, not your real password.

You will see: a new folder called **junsgarden** containing the website code.

Part 2 - Reading the code with an AI

You do not need to learn PHP to look after this website. You need to be able to ask good questions about it. This part gives you the questions.

Every important file now starts with a comment block that explains what the file does and what to ask about it. **Read that block first, before anything else in the file.**

How to ask

1	Open the file you are curious about in Notepad. You will see: A lot of text. This is normal. Do not try to read it all.
2	Select all of it and copy it.
3	Go to **`gemini.google.com`** and start a new chat. You will see: An empty chat box.
4	Paste the file. **Before** pressing Enter, type your question above it.
5	Press Enter and read the answer. You will see: An explanation in plain words.

Questions that work well

"Explain what this PHP file does, in simple terms, in ten lines or fewer."

"What would break on the website if I deleted this file?"

"I want to change the words in the green box at the top. Which exact line do I edit, and what do I leave alone?"

"Is there anything in this file that would be dangerous to change?"

"What does the he() function do and why is it used here?"

Questions that do not work well

"Fix this file." - too vague. The AI does not know what is wrong.

"Rewrite this to be better." - it will change working code for no reason and you will not know what moved.

Always ask what a change does before you make it. An AI will happily hand you a confident answer that is wrong.

Part 3 - Making a change safely

This is the safe loop. Do it in this order every time.

1 Make sure your copy is up to date. In the junsgarden folder, run:

```
git pull
```

1 Edit the file in Notepad. Change one thing. Not five.

You will see: Your change in the file.

2 Ask Git what you changed:

```
git diff
```

You will see: lines starting with a minus sign (removed) and a plus sign (added). **If you see changes you did not mean to make, stop.**

1 If it looks wrong, throw the change away and start again:

```
git checkout -- name-of-the-file.php
```

1 If it looks right, save it and send it to the server:

```
git add -A
git commit -m "say what you changed"
git push
```

What push does and does not do

push sends your change to Gitea, where Jason can see it.

It does **not** put your change on the live website by itself. Jason applies it to the server.

This is deliberate. It means a mistake in your copy can never take the website down.

Part 4 - Seeing what has changed

You can look at every change ever made, at any time.

In the browser: go to https://jasonagibson.zapto.org/git/ and open the **junsgarden** repository. Click **Commits**. Each entry is one change, with the date and who made it. Click one to see exactly what moved.

On your computer:

```
git log --oneline
```

To collect the newest changes into your copy:

```
git pull
```

What is not in the code copy

Some things are deliberately left out of the repository. If you were looking for them, this is why they are missing.

Missing	Why
The plant photos	Over 1,250 files, 400MB. Backed up separately
.env files	They hold live keys and passwords
The Android APK	64MB. It is on the website instead
Database dumps	They hold all the real data

Never do these

1. Never put a password or a key into a file you commit. If you are unsure whether something is a key, ask before pushing.

2. Never edit files directly on the server. Edit your copy, push, and let Jason apply it.

3. Never accept an AI's code change without asking what it does first.

4. Never change **connection.php** on your own. Every page depends on it.